

AR Calling Training Course

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Module 1: What is AR Calling?

AR (Accounts Receivable) Calling is the process of following up with insurance companies to collect unpaid claims. As an AR Caller, you contact insurance payers to check claim status, resolve denials, and recover revenue for healthcare providers.

Key Responsibilities: Monitor claims daily - check status, identify unpaid claims, track aging (0-30, 30-60, 60-90+ days)

Follow up with insurance - call for status, resolve denials, request reprocessing, file appeals

Document everything - log every call, record reference numbers, update claim status, track follow-up dates

Recover revenue - maximize collections, reduce denial rate, improve cash flow

Module 2: Key Roles in US Healthcare

PCP (Primary Care Physician):

First point of contact for patients

General health checkups, preventive care, minor illness treatment

Manages ongoing conditions, provides referrals to specialists

Provider (Any Healthcare Professional):

Any healthcare professional who delivers care - PCPs, Specialists, Hospitals, Nurses, Therapists

Every PCP is a Provider, but NOT every Provider is a PCP

In Billing:

Rendering Provider = who saw the patient

Referring Provider = the PCP who sent them

Billing Provider = who gets paid

Module 3: Claim Processing Flow

1. Patient Visit - Patient sees doctor, services provided
2. Code Assignment - ICD-10 (diagnosis) + CPT (procedure) codes assigned
3. Charge Entry - Charges entered into billing system
4. Claim Creation - CMS-1500 form generated with all details
5. Scrubbing - Auto validation checks (DOB, insurance ID, NPI, codes)
6. Submission - Claim sent electronically (EDI 837 format) via clearinghouse
7. Adjudication - Insurance reviews and decides (5 checks: Eligibility, Coverage, Auth, Network, Necessity)
8. Payment/Denial - Insurance pays (ERA/835) or denies with reason code
9. Follow-up - AR Caller resolves issues and recovers revenue
10. Payment Posting - Payment applied to patient account

Module 4: Claim Adjudication - 5 Insurance Checks

When insurance receives a claim, they run 5 checks:

1. ELIGIBILITY - Was patient insured on the Date of Service?
2. COVERAGE - Are these services covered under the plan?
3. PRIOR AUTHORIZATION - Was authorization obtained (if required)?
4. IN-NETWORK - Is the provider contracted with the insurance?
5. MEDICAL NECESSITY - Does the diagnosis match the procedure?

Payment Calculation Example: Billed: \$500 | Allowed: \$400 | Write-off: \$100 (contractual adjustment)

Insurance pays 80%: \$320 | Patient owes 20%: \$80

Module 5: 25 AR Calling Scenarios (Quick Reference)

1. **DED - Claim Applied Towards Deductible**
Action: Bill patient or secondary insurance
2. **EFT/CIP - Claim Paid via EFT/Direct Deposit**
Action: Verify EFT#, check if cashed, post payment
3. **PTWA - Paid to Incorrect Address**
Action: Send corrected W9, escalate to supervisor
4. **COD - Denied as Inclusive/Incidental**
Action: Add modifier (-59), resubmit claim
5. **DUP - Denied as Duplicate**
Action: Find original claim, work that one instead

6. BILL PT - Claim Paid to Patient

Action: Check AOB, transfer balance to patient

7. CNOF - Claim Not on File

Action: Get fax#, rebill. Check clearinghouse first

8. CIP - Claim in Process

Action: Follow TAT, set reminder, call back

9. ELIG - Denied for Eligibility

Action: Get corrected ID, bill patient if no other insurance

10. PCP - Denied for Referral

Action: Get PCP info, add to claim, refile

11. PRIEOB - Denied for Primary EOB

Action: Attach primary EOB, rebill

12. NOAUTH - Denied for Prior Authorization

Action: Try retro auth, update PCP info

13. MAXB - Max Benefit Exhausted

Action: Check secondary insurance, bill patient

14. NCS(P) - Non-Covered Services - Patient

Action: Bill secondary payer / patient

15. NCS(Pr) - Non-Covered Services - Provider

Action: Escalate to Coding team

16. NMN - Not Medically Necessary

Action: Appeal with medical records

17. PPMAX - Primary Paid Maximum

Action: Bill coinsurance or write off

18. ADDLINFO - Additional Info Required (Provider)

Action: Request docs from practice

19. PT-ADDL - Additional Info Required (Patient)

Action: Request letter to patient

20. PNC - Provider Not Contracted

Action: Verify NPI, escalate or write off

21. DTF - Denied - Timely Filing

Action: Appeal with POTF evidence

22. OFFSET - Applied Towards Offset

Action: Escalate to posting team

23. RPRICE - Sent for Re-Pricing

Action: Call repricing agency directly

24. CAP - Applied Towards Capitation

Action: Adjust as capitation

25. PPMAX2 - Primary Paid Maximum (Secondary)

Action: Bill patient coinsurance

Module 6: Questions to Ask Insurance (by Scenario Type)

DED - Deductible:

What is the processed date and claim #?

How much was allowed and applied towards deductible?

Was it processed in-network or out of network?

Do you find any other insurance for this patient?

Could you fax/mail me a copy of the EOB?

CNOF - Claim Not on File:

Do you have any Clearinghouse rejections at your end?

May I have the claims mailing address and Payer id?

Is the patient eligible for the DOS?

May I have the fax # so I can fax this claim?

May I have the filing limit for this claim?

NOAUTH - No Prior Authorization:

Which service requires authorization and why?

Can we appeal with Medical Records for retro authorization?

What is the time limit for appeal?

Could you give me the fax number/mailling address?

NCS - Non-Covered Services:

- Could you tell me the services that are not covered under this plan?
- Can we appeal with medical records?
- Do you find any other insurance for this patient?

DTF - Denied Timely Filing:

- May I have the date when the claim was received?
- May I have the filing limit for this claim?
- Do you accept electronic receipts as proof of timely filing?
- What is the appealing limit and fax #?

Module 7: Common Denial Codes

CO-4 - Procedure Code Issue

Fix: Check for duplicate/bundled codes

CO-16 - Missing Claim Info

Fix: Add missing diagnosis/referral

CO-23 - Exceeds Authorization Amount

Fix: Adjust to auth amount or appeal

CO-29 - Filing Deadline Passed

Fix: Appeal with valid reason

CO-109 - Provider Not in Network

Fix: Verify network status or balance bill

CO-197 - No Prior Authorization

Fix: Get auth retroactively or appeal

PR-1 - Patient Deductible

Fix: Bill patient for deductible

PR-2 - Patient Coinsurance

Fix: Bill patient for 20%

PR-3 - Patient Copay

Fix: Bill patient for copay amount

Module 8: Golden Rules of AR Calling

1. Always ask for the EOB in every denial call
2. Always get a reference number before hanging up
3. Always document the call details
4. Always check for secondary insurance before billing the patient
5. Always verify NPI before calling
6. Always check clearinghouse for rejections first
7. Rendering Provider = who saw the patient
8. Referring Provider = PCP who referred them
9. Billing Provider = who gets paid

Module 9: Master Glossary

AR: Accounts Receivable

PCP: Primary Care Physician

NPI: National Provider Identifier

EOB: Explanation of Benefits

ERA: Electronic Remittance Advice (EDI 835)

EFT: Electronic Funds Transfer

EDI 837: Electronic claim submission format

CMS-1500: Professional services claim form

ICD-10: Diagnosis codes

CPT: Procedure codes

DOS: Date of Service

TAT: Turn Around Time

COB: Coordination of Benefits

AOB: Assignment of Benefits

LCD: Local Coverage Determination

NCD: National Coverage Determination

W9: IRS tax form for provider payment

POTF: Proof of Timely Filing

Capitation: Per-member-per-month payment model

Provision AR Training Center

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Good luck with your AR Calling career!